SPORTS

Keystone buries W. Reserve at foul line

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

LAGRANGE — Warning to area basketball teams with Keystone on its schedule.

Don't put the Wildcats on the free throw line.

Keystone shot a sizzling 90 percent (19 of 21) from the line Saturday in easing past Western Reserve, 62-45, in non-conference play. It doesn't get much better than that.

"The free throws were good," said Keystone coach Greg Morgan, "but I don't think we played as focused as we have. We weren't active in the defensive passing lanes and we weren't on the boards. Our shot selection wasn't real good. We have some things to work on."

That may be the scariest part of the Wildcats. They can only get better.

BOYS BASKETBALL

Yes, junior Brett Bartlett finished with 20 points, but he was far from the sharpshooter he'll be once he regains his legs from football. He threw up 17 shots — four from the three-point land — with seven of his field goals falling and one of the 3-pointers.

"He hasn't shot that well yet," Morgan said of Bartlett, "which is good. He's just starting to get strong enough to start hitting the threes. He may not be shooting as well but he's going to eventually."

D.J. Shaw, Bartlett's underrated sidekick, finished with 16 points, eight rebounds and a terrific blocked shot, where he sprang out of nowhere to swat the ball into the bleachers on the stage. Shaw and Bartlett combined to sink 13 of their 14 foul shots — the lone miss being Bartlett's in the second quarter. But when the heat was on in the final quarter, the Wildcats were a perfect 10 of 10.

"He's been sick — he was out of school (Friday)," Morgan said of Shaw. "He's been really stepping up. He's going to make a difference for us this year."

Big Chase Clawser, the 6-foot-8, 325-pound junior man in the middle, showed flashes of greatness, but scored only six points and grabbed just a six rebounds. He did have one huge blocked shot.

Add the complement of role players and Keystone should be primed to make a run at the Lorain County Conference, starting this Friday, when play begins at Avon.

Sophomores Todd Schlenkerman (6 of 6 from the line) and Jason Moore (eight points) contributed to the victory. Juniors Steve Clement (five rebounds) and Jeff Denham played their part Saturday as well. The lone senior — Todd Conrad — also had a solid game.

Give the Rough Riders credit. They never gave up. They played hard all night long. Keystone earned the victory, its third in as many outings. Western Reserve fell to 1-2, but it's been against top-notch competition.

"We're a very young ballclub," said first-year coach Chris Sheldon. "We're learning as we go. It's a new system, a new coach, a new philosophy but our kids — the greatest thing about them so far — they're tough kids. They haven't backed down from anyone."

Sheldon may be young but he has great coaching lineage. His father Rob played basketball at Elyria High and has been a longtime coach at Wynford. His grandfather John was practically an institution as a longtime assistant football coach at Elyria High before retiring.

Shawn Shriver led the Rough Riders with 19 points while, Kyle Kramer — at just 6-2 — picked off 10 rebounds.

WESTERN RESERVE (45): Phil Lewis 2-0-6, Kyle Kramer 2-3-7, Shawn Shriver 5-6-19, Chris Jarrett 2-0-4, Caleb Buck 0-0-0, Kenton Garwood 1-0-2, Brad Buckingham 2-0-5, Dennis Lee 1-0-2, Jon Lee 0-0-0. **Totals 18-9-45.**
KEYSTONE (62) D. J. Shaw 4-8-16, Todd Schlenkerman 1-6-8, Brett Bartlett 7-5-20, Jeff Denham 1-0-2, Chase Clowser 3-0-6, Steve Clement 0-0-0, Todd Conrad 1-0-2, Jason Moore 4-0-8. **Totals 21-19-62.**
Field goals: Western 16-46 (35 percent), Keystone 21-47 (45 percent). **Free Throws:** Western 9-13 (69 percent), Keystone 19-21 (90 percent). **Rebounds:** Western 30 (Kramer 10), Keystone 34 (Shaw 8). **Turnovers:** Western 17, Keystone 11. **Fouls: Western** 20, Keystone 17. **Fouled Out:** Lewis

Western Reserve	13	11	9	12	—	45
Keystone	15	19	14	14	—	62

Three-pointers: Western (4-16) Lewis 2, Buckingham, Shriver. Keystone (1-11) Bartlett.
Junior Varsity: Western Reserve 68-41.

BOYS BASKETBALL

Defense, Neal lift LC to victory

Steve Byrne
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — It was a game between two teams trying to deal with tough losses.

Lorain Catholic was looking to come back one night after falling to arch-rival Elyria Catholic. Clearview was attempting to deal with the absence of two starters, including one who averaged 23 points a game last season.

Lorain Catholic prevailed, 47-39, thanks mainly to a terrific defensive effort and Brandon Neal's 18 points.

"We knew we were going to be fatigued," LC coach Matt Lawhead said. "We weren't going to be sharp. We weren't going to hit on all cylinders. We were going to be tested mentally."

The Spartans passed the test by dominating most of the fourth period after Clearview had gotten to within a point to begin the quarter. LC (2-1) pushed out to a nine-point lead with 3 1/2 minutes to play, then survived some shakiness at the offensive end before hitting five straight free throws over the final 20 seconds.

"The kids showed what they were made of tonight," Lawhead said. "They are good kids and they're beginning to buy into the system, and I'm proud of what they did in this game.

"Defense around the perimeter is going to be our bread and butter. That's what did it for us tonight, especially in the second half."

Clearview, playing without Chad Szalay, the county's top returning scorer from the 2001-02 season, fell to 0-2. Szalay suffered a knee injury in the season opener and is out for the year.

The Clippers were also minus senior post player Marcus Little, because of illness.

"Our effort tonight was a lot better than the effort on the first night," Clearview coach John Szalay said, referring to his team's loss to Columbia. "We did a lot of things right, and I'm happy with the improvement. Lorain Catholic is a team that isn't going to beat itself."

The Clippers were hurt by LC's full-court pressure and half-court trapping, plus some crisp backdoor cuts, in the fourth. The Spartans bothered Clearview into six turnovers in the first four minutes of the last period and outscored the Clippers 11-3 to go ahead 42-33.

"We had some football legs out there," Szalay said. "We were a little weary in the last quarter. We knew what to do but our legs didn't get there on some plays."

Clearview is coming off participation in the football playoffs. Eight of the 10 players on the Clippers' roster were on the football team.

Lorain Catholic never trailed. A three-point play by Adam Tubbs broke an 8-8 tie and put the Spartans in the lead for good with 1:30 remaining in the first period.

The Spartans led by as many as seven points late in the second quarter and early in the third before Clearview began to narrow the margin. The Clippers outscored LC 12-6 over the final seven minutes of the third period to trail 31-30 by the start of the fourth.

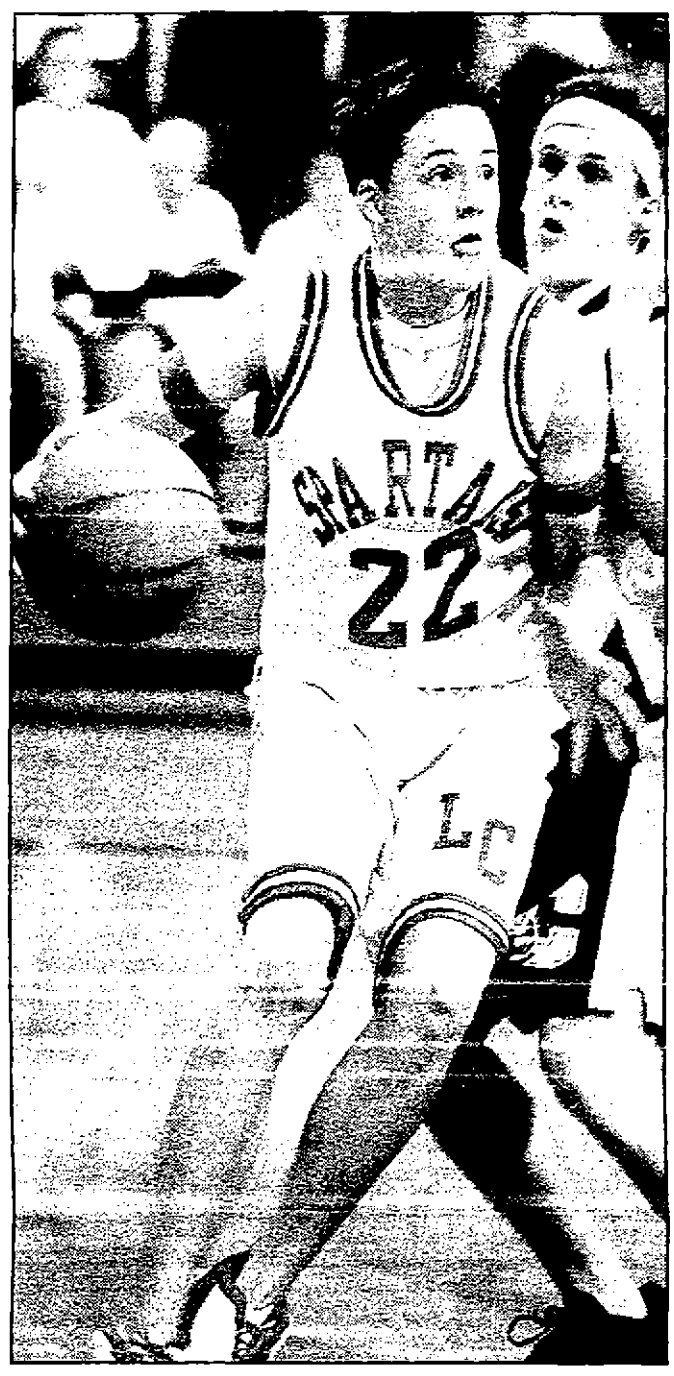
Michael Cruz's three-point basket at 3:30 gave LC its nine-point lead, but it would be the last field goal the Spartans would have. LC committed five turnovers in the last four minutes and Clearview scored six unanswered points to make the score 42-39 with 1:17 to play.

Neal was fouled with 38.8 seconds left, but missed the first of his one-and-one chance. Chris Dalton grabbed the rebound and was fouled with 33.9 to go. Dalton made the first of his free throws.

Dalton hit four more foul shots. He rebounded Louis Thomas's missed three-point attempt and was fouled with 18.4 seconds remaining. He sank his final two with a 1.4 to play.

Thomas led Clearview with 14 points. Montress Sharpe was high rebounder with 11 and Jeff Gantz led all playmakers with five assists.

Lorain Catholic made 17 of 37 field-goal attempts.



TOM MAHL / CHRONICLE

SPARTAN SPUNK: Lorain Catholic's Chris Dalton drives around Clearview's Joey Bandagski during the Spartans' victory Saturday night.

CLEARVIEW (39): Manny Thames 2-0-4, Jeff Gantz 0-0-0, Louis Thomas 6-0-14, Montress Sharpe 4-1-9, Jarrett Buckosh 5-0-10, Brandon Ammons 0-0-0, Ryan Anderson 0-0-0, Dan Rohner 0-0-0, Andrew Stanchak 0-2-2, Joe Bandagski 0-0-0. **Totals 17-3-39.**
LORAIN CATHOLIC (47): Michael Cruz 2-0-6, Chris Dalton 2-6-10, Adam Tubbs 3-1-7, Nick Mezlak 2-0-4, Brandon Neal 7-4-18, Bill Waters 1-0-2, Zak Schue 0-0-0, Matt Ksiazk 0-0-0. **Totals 17-11-47.**

Clearview	10	8	12	9	—	39
Lorain Catholic	11	12	8	16	—	47

Three-point goals: Clearview 2 (Thomas 2). Lorain Catholic 2 (Cruz 2). **Rebounds:** Clearview 24 (Sharpe 11). Lorain Catholic 16 (Dalton 5). **Turnovers:** Clearview 26, Lorain Catholic 19. **Fouled out:** None.
Junior varsity: Lorain Catholic, 45-25.

BOYS BASKETBALL ROUNDUP

Olmsted Falls stays unbeaten

OLMSTED FALLS — Olmsted Falls grabbed a 27-17 lead after one quarter and was never challenged in an 82-67 victory over Ottawa Glandorf on Saturday.

Steve Gansey led the 3-0 Bulldogs with 33 points, including four 3-pointers.

Dan Binggeli (15) and Tim Curran (14) joined Gansey in double figures for Olmsted Falls.

OTTAWA GLANDORF (67): Imm 3-0-7, Pothast 1-0-2, Ruhe 1-2-4, E. Politz 10-1-21, T. Politz 14-5-33. **Totals 29-8-67.**
OLMSTED FALLS (82): Binggeli 6-3-15, Braddick 1-0-2, Scales 2-1-5, Curran 4-6-14, Sparks 3-1-8, Gansey 13-3-33, Mental 1-2-5. **Totals 30-16-82.**

Ottawa Glandorf	17	9	25	16	—	67
Olmsted Falls	27	17	20	18	—	82

Three-pointers: (OG) Imm. **(OF)** Sparks, Gansey 4, Mental.
Junior varsity: Ottawa Glandorf, 71-39.

Midview 62, Cloverleaf 36

GRAFTON — Ryan Feierabend scored a game-high 26 points, including the game's only 3-pointer, as Midview (1-2) won its first game.

The Middies outscored Cloverleaf in every quarter, leading 38-20 at halftime.

Feierabend was the only Midview player in double figures.

CLOVERLEAF (36): Kuzyk 1-0-2, Andrews 1-0-2, Skidmore 1-0-2, Hewit 2-2-6, Siekbert 1-2-4, Holdiman 1-0-2, Predmetski 6-0-12, Snook 3-0-6. **Totals 16-4-36.**
MIDVIEW (62): Kushner 3-0-6, Ries 3-0-6, Ross 1-0-2, Worley 2-0-4, Molstad 3-1-7, Bales 2-1-5, DiFranco 3-0-6, Feierabend 9-7-26 **Totals 26-9-62.**

Cloverleaf	10	10	6	10	—	36
Midview	26	12	9	15	—	62

Three-pointers: (M) Feierabend.
Junior varsity: Midview, 58-44.

North Olmsted 41, Padua 30

PARMA — Steve Trapp and Matt Hagen combined for 19 points for the Eagles, who outscored Padua 26-14 over the second and third quarters after the two teams were tied at six at the end of the first quarter.

Hagen had two of North Olmsted's three 3-pointers.

NORTH OLMSTED (41): Zajac 0-1-1, Easter 1-09-2, Janis 1-0-3, Hibinger 0-1-1, Hagen 3-1-9, Trapp 4-2-10, Eccleston 2-1-5, Connors 2-2-6, Rogalski 2-0-4. **Totals 15-8-41.**
PADUA (30): Toth 3-0-6, Apathy 1-3-5, Jankowski 2-1-6, Quirring 1-0-2, Hurni 2-3-7, Kocin 2-0-4. **Totals 11-7-30.**

North Olmsted	6	12	14	9	—	41
Padua	6	5	9	10	—	30

Three-pointers: (NO) Janis, Hagen 2. **(P)** Jankowski.
Junior varsity: North Olmsted, 39-25.

MAC-8

Columbia 60, Beachwood 38

COLUMBIA STATION — Matt Stefancin scored 17 points to lead three Raiders (2-1, 1-0 MAC-8) in MAC-8 action.

Rich Gentry (12) and Ben Magda (11) joined Stefancin in double figures for Columbia's scorebook.

BEACHWOOD (38): Winograd 8-0-17, Rollins 0-2-2, Wasserman 4-1-10, Haynes 1-0-3, Weiss 1-2-4, Price 0-2-2. **Totals 14-7-38.**
COLUMBIA (60): Gentry 5-0-12, Gerbick 1-0-2, Stefancin 8-0-17, Suntala 2-4-8, Boey 0-2-2, Magda 5-1-11, Vyrostek 3-0-6, Solonics 1-0-2. **Totals 25-7-60.**

Beachwood	10	15	5	8	—	38
Columbia	18	12	16	14	—	60

Three-pointers: (B) Winograd, Wasserman, Haynes. **(C)** Gentry 2, Stefancin.
Junior varsity: Columbia, 54-43.

Gilmour 77, Lutheran West 68

GATES MILLS — The unbeaten Lancers (3-0, 1-0 MAC-8) outscored Lutheran West in every quarter of this high-scoring game.

The Longhorns had five double-figure scorers as their overall record dropped to 0-2 after their first conference game.

LUTHERAN WEST (68): Spurlock 4-2-10, Ronschke 4-2-13, Davila 4-0-10, Minnick 5-2-12, Senrau 7-3-17, Schiffnk 0-1-1, Morrison 1-3-5. **Totals 25-13-68.**
GILMOUR (77): Komperda 4-3-15, Nardy 1-0-2, Ravida 5-3-14, Herbe 6-0-14, Hyland 4-1-12, Eggleston 4-3-11, Kearney 3-1-9. **Totals 27-11-77.**

Lutheran West	21	18	15	14	—	68
Gilmour	23	19	17	18	—	77

Three-pointers: (LW) Ronschke 3, Davila 2. **(G)** Komperda 4, Ravida, Herbe 2, Hyland 3, Kearney 2.
Junior varsity: Lutheran West, 76-57.

Fuchs Mizrachi 48, First Baptist 35

UNIVERSITY HTS. — Fuchs Mizrachi's boys jumped out to a 9-0 lead after one quarter as they won their first game.

Denny Reaser led the Sabres (0-2) with 15 points, while Matt Henry added 11.

FIRST BAPTIST (35): Henry 4-1-11, Reaser 6-1-15, Berghaus 0-2-2, Fulks 1-2-4, Parker 1-1-3. **Totals 12-7-35.**
FUCHS MIZRACHI (48): Weiner 2-0-4, Smith 2-1-6, Ho 6-1-15, Gottesman 1-2-4, N. Katz 7-5-19. **Totals 18-9-48.**

First Baptist	0	15	7	13	—	35
Fuchs Mizrachi	9	12	16	11	—	48

Three-pointers: (FB) Henry 2, Reaser 2. **(FM)** Smith, Ho 2.

PIONEERS

From D1

The Redmen amassed 278.5 points.

A quicker and stronger Matt Rabung got the area's other title as he successfully defended his 112-pound championship.

The North Ridgeville senior overpowered Normandy senior Jon Buchholz 10-3. The two-time state qualifier executed three takedowns, a reversal and two near-fall points for the win.

"I came to do what I had to do," Rabung said. "I lifted in the off-season and I could tell it paid off in my performance today. The hard work is paying off."

Perez captured the area's second and Elyria's first title, manhandling Bellevue junior Quenton Smith 12-6. Perez has climbed the ladder at this tournament, finishing third as a freshman and second last season. Smith, third in the state in Division II in March, couldn't handle the speed and agility of Perez.

Even Perez, fifth in the state as a freshman and a qualifier last year, was amazed at his margin of victory.

"I thought it was going to be a closer match, but when I finish my shots, I'm pretty unstoppable," Perez said. "I felt really good out there tonight. It helps having good workout partners. It has improved my endurance."

Perez nailed five takedowns and a pair of near-fall points for his victory.

FINAL TEAM STANDINGS
Bellevue 278.5, Elyria 214.5, Normandy 201.5, Padua 164, Amherst 138, North Ridgeville 133, Valley Forge 88.5, Elyria Catholic 84, Lakewood 71.5, Avon Lake 59.5, Admiral King 58, Vermilion 51, Brookside 47, Bay 31, Oberlin 26, Warrensville Hts. 21.

CHAMPIONSHIP RESULTS
103 — McLemore (PAD) pin Levine (AM) :50. Third: Yesenko (NR) dec. Lem (AL) 12-4. Fifth: Heath (BEL) pin Matis (NOR) 5:38.
112 — Rabung (NR) dec. Buchholz (NOR) 10-3. Third: Macko (PAD) dec. Little (EL) 5-2. Fifth: Brunner (AL) tech.fall Crowe (VF) 15-0.
119 — Perez (EL) dec. Smith (BEL) 12-6. Third: Jungschaffer (OB) dec. Buchholz (PAD) 7-6. Fifth: Johnson (BR) pin Gusteley (NR) 3:27.
125 — P. Felton (EL) dec. Lee (LK) 12-5. Third: Chapin (BEL) dec. Haber (NOR) 9-4. Fifth: Sedar (VER) dec. Teets (AL) 9-7.
130 — Smith (BEL) pin Cook (AK) 2:30. Third: M. Felton (EL) dec. Lewis (LW) 4-2. Fifth: Patton (PAD) dec. Winebrenner (AM) 11-5.
135 — Bottomlee (EL) dec. Powers (BEL) 8-1. Third: Jordan (BAY) dec. Lewis (LK) 9-2. Fifth: Rankin (NR) by default over Jones (WH).
140 — Spurlock (BEL) pin Taylor (EC) 3:02. Third: Cornhoff (VF) pin Logsdon (AM) 4:32. Fifth: Green (PAD) pin Hansen (NOR) 2:50.
145 — Gross (PAD) pin Pelton (BEL) 3:03. Third: Holztrager (NOR) pin Parsons (EL) 2:52. Fifth: Dabney (VER) dec. Schultz (EC) 17-7.
152 — Riggleman (BEL) pin Kloss (PAD) 5:47. Third: Gee (NOR) dec. Brumenschenkel (AM) 5-3. Fifth: Erker (VF) dec. Fike (BR) 4-0.
160 — Stettin (NOR) dec. Hickey (EC) 5-2. Third: Malott (BEL) dec. Walling (NR) 6-5. Fifth: Tolson (PAD) dec. P. Sen (EL) 10-2.
171 — Good (NOR) dec. Koval (VF) 1-4. Third: J. Sen (EL) dec. Malott (BEL) 12-2. Fifth: Lupica (AL) dec. Mazza (VER) 5-3.
189 — Hunter (BEL) pin Rios (NR) 2:50. Third: Waller (AM) dec. Bennett (AL) 7-2. Fifth: Misovic (NOR) dec. Lewis (AK) 6-4.
215 — Radva (NOR) dec. Bachna (EC) 6-2. Third: Faught (EL) pin Winemiller (AM) 5:44. Fifth: Green (BEL) pin Reinhart (NR) 2:04
275 — Fitzpatrick (EL) dec. Avolt (AM) 1-1. 3rd: Emery, Third: Eggleston (BEL) pin Kaminski (PAD). Fifth: English (AK) pin Garofalo (NOR) :49.

Felton jumped from a fourth-place showing last season to becoming the 125-pound champion this time around. The two-time state qualifier dominated Lakewood senior Dan Lee 12-5 on the strength of two take-

"It's the fourth time I've wrestled Lee," Felton said. "I've beaten him every time, but I always have to be on guard for something new he might throw at me. Winning this tournament is a big boost for me. It's a great way to start off the season. Everyone on our team is excited. We all just wanted to go out and do whatever we could do for the team."

Bottomlee earned Pioneer crown No. 3, handing Bellevue senior Jim Powers an 8-1 loss in the 135-pound championship.

"Everything went just as I hoped it would," Bottomlee said. "I placed third here last year. I worked hard in the off-season to improve. It was definitely easier this year. It also helped that the team is doing so good."

Fitzpatrick won the evening finale on overtime criteria.

Following seven minutes of wrestling, the score stood tied at 1 with Amherst senior Chris Avolt, each having earned an escape. Avolt took the down position but couldn't escape in the allotted 30 seconds.

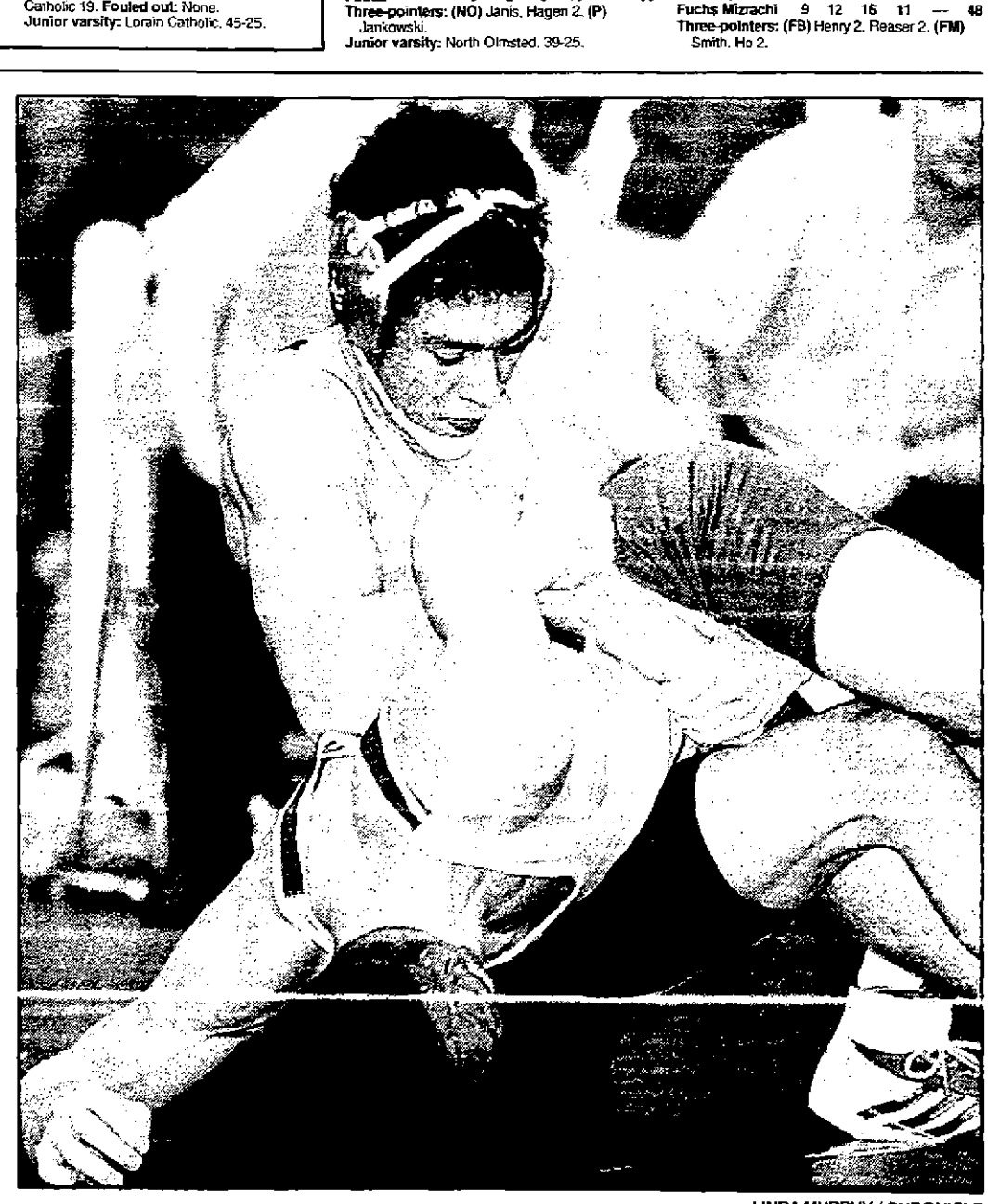
In addition to Avolt, six local wrestlers earned runner-up honors.

Amherst junior Jake Levine became Padua freshman Pat McLemore's fourth victim in the 103-pound championship match. McLemore pinned all four matches, flattening Levine in 50 seconds.

After three first-period falls, Admiral King senior state qualifier Jayson Cook met his match in the 130-pound championship, getting pinned by Bellevue senior Joe Smith at 2:30. Smith was voted the tourney's Most Valuable Wrestler.

Elyria Catholic received second-place finishes from 160-pound juniors R.J. Hickey and Brian Bachna (215) and 140-pound senior Jeremy Taylor. Hickey and Bachna lost to Normandy seniors, Hickey by a 5-2 margin. Bachna suffered a 6-2 setback at the hands of Rudy Radva. Taylor was pinned by Bellevue senior Luke Spurlock.

North Ridgeville senior Adam Rios earned a second at 215 pounds.



LINDA MURPHY / CHRONICLE

GRIPPING ACTION: Elyria's Alec Bottomlee, top, works over Bellevue's Jim Powers en route to a victory in the 135-pound weight class at the Knights of Columbus Invitational

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